

# Men's Ballon d'Or

France Football created the Ballon d'Or in 1956. Eligibility rules changed over time: the award was initially limited to European players, opened to players of any nationality at European clubs in 1995, and became fully global in 2007. From 2010 through 2015 it was presented jointly with FIFA.

## Men's Ballon d'Or winners, 1956 to present

| Year | Winner                   | National team |
|------|--------------------------|---------------|
| 2025 | <b>Ousmane Dembélé</b>   | France        |
| 2024 | <b>Rodri</b>             | Spain         |
| 2023 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina     |
| 2022 | <b>Karim Benzema</b>     | France        |
| 2021 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina     |
| 2020 | <b>Not awarded</b>       | —             |
| 2019 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina     |
| 2018 | <b>Luka Modrić</b>       | Croatia       |
| 2017 | <b>Cristiano Ronaldo</b> | Portugal      |

| Year | Winner                   | National team  |
|------|--------------------------|----------------|
| 2016 | <b>Cristiano Ronaldo</b> | Portugal       |
| 2015 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina      |
| 2014 | <b>Cristiano Ronaldo</b> | Portugal       |
| 2013 | <b>Cristiano Ronaldo</b> | Portugal       |
| 2012 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina      |
| 2011 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina      |
| 2010 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina      |
| 2009 | <b>Lionel Messi</b>      | Argentina      |
| 2008 | <b>Cristiano Ronaldo</b> | Portugal       |
| 2007 | <b>Kaká</b>              | Brazil         |
| 2006 | <b>Fabio Cannavaro</b>   | Italy          |
| 2005 | <b>Ronaldinho</b>        | Brazil         |
| 2004 | <b>Andriy Shevchenko</b> | Ukraine        |
| 2003 | <b>Pavel Nedvěd</b>      | Czech Republic |
| 2002 | <b>Ronaldo</b>           | Brazil         |
| 2001 | <b>Michael Owen</b>      | England        |

| Year | Winner                   | National team |
|------|--------------------------|---------------|
| 2000 | <b>Luís Figo</b>         | Portugal      |
| 1999 | <b>Rivaldo</b>           | Brazil        |
| 1998 | <b>Zinedine Zidane</b>   | France        |
| 1997 | <b>Ronaldo</b>           | Brazil        |
| 1996 | <b>Matthias Sammer</b>   | Germany       |
| 1995 | <b>George Weah</b>       | Liberia       |
| 1994 | <b>Hristo Stoichkov</b>  | Bulgaria      |
| 1993 | <b>Roberto Baggio</b>    | Italy         |
| 1992 | <b>Marco van Basten</b>  | Netherlands   |
| 1991 | <b>Jean-Pierre Papin</b> | France        |
| 1990 | <b>Lothar Matthäus</b>   | West Germany  |
| 1989 | <b>Marco van Basten</b>  | Netherlands   |
| 1988 | <b>Marco van Basten</b>  | Netherlands   |
| 1987 | <b>Ruud Gullit</b>       | Netherlands   |
| 1986 | <b>Igor Belanov</b>      | Soviet Union  |
| 1985 | <b>Michel Platini</b>    | France        |

| Year | Winner                       | National team |
|------|------------------------------|---------------|
| 1984 | <b>Michel Platini</b>        | France        |
| 1983 | <b>Michel Platini</b>        | France        |
| 1982 | <b>Paolo Rossi</b>           | Italy         |
| 1981 | <b>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</b> | West Germany  |
| 1980 | <b>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</b> | West Germany  |
| 1979 | <b>Kevin Keegan</b>          | England       |
| 1978 | <b>Kevin Keegan</b>          | England       |
| 1977 | <b>Allan Simonsen</b>        | Denmark       |
| 1976 | <b>Franz Beckenbauer</b>     | West Germany  |
| 1975 | <b>Oleg Blokhin</b>          | Soviet Union  |
| 1974 | <b>Johan Cruyff</b>          | Netherlands   |
| 1973 | <b>Johan Cruyff</b>          | Netherlands   |
| 1972 | <b>Franz Beckenbauer</b>     | West Germany  |
| 1971 | <b>Johan Cruyff</b>          | Netherlands   |
| 1970 | <b>Gerd Müller</b>           | West Germany  |
| 1969 | <b>Gianni Rivera</b>         | Italy         |

| Year | Winner                    | National team    |
|------|---------------------------|------------------|
| 1968 | <b>George Best</b>        | Northern Ireland |
| 1967 | <b>Flórián Albert</b>     | Hungary          |
| 1966 | <b>Bobby Charlton</b>     | England          |
| 1965 | <b>Eusébio</b>            | Portugal         |
| 1964 | <b>Denis Law</b>          | Scotland         |
| 1963 | <b>Lev Yashin</b>         | Soviet Union     |
| 1962 | <b>Josef Masopust</b>     | Czechoslovakia   |
| 1961 | <b>Omar Sívori</b>        | Italy            |
| 1960 | <b>Luis Suárez</b>        | Spain            |
| 1959 | <b>Alfredo Di Stéfano</b> | Spain            |
| 1958 | <b>Raymond Kopa</b>       | France           |
| 1957 | <b>Alfredo Di Stéfano</b> | Spain            |
| 1956 | <b>Stanley Matthews</b>   | England          |

## Champions by titles

Generated automatically from the edition table above. Totals group a nation with its sporting predecessor only where the source content does (Germany includes West Germany); every other name is counted as written.

|                                                |   |
|------------------------------------------------|---|
| <b>Lionel Messi</b><br><div></div>             | 8 |
| 2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023 |   |
| <b>Cristiano Ronaldo</b><br><div></div>        | 5 |
| 2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017                   |   |
| <b>Johan Cruyff</b><br><div></div>             | 3 |
| 1971, 1973, 1974                               |   |
| <b>Michel Platini</b><br><div></div>           | 3 |
| 1983, 1984, 1985                               |   |
| <b>Marco van Basten</b><br><div></div>         | 3 |
| 1988, 1989, 1992                               |   |
| <b>Alfredo Di Stéfano</b><br><div></div>       | 2 |
| 1957, 1959                                     |   |
| <b>Franz Beckenbauer</b><br><div></div>        | 2 |
| 1972, 1976                                     |   |
| <b>Kevin Keegan</b><br><div></div>             | 2 |
| 1978, 1979                                     |   |
| <b>Karl-Heinz Rummenigge</b><br><div></div>    | 2 |
| 1980, 1981                                     |   |

|                                                                                                                      |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Ronaldo</b><br><br>1997, 2002    | <b>2</b> |
| <b>Stanley Matthews</b><br><br>1956 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Raymond Kopa</b><br><br>1958     | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Luis Suárez</b><br><br>1960      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Omar Sívori</b><br><br>1961      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Josef Masopust</b><br><br>1962   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Lev Yashin</b><br><br>1963     | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Denis Law</b><br><br>1964      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Eusébio</b><br><br>1965        | <b>1</b> |

|                                                                                                                      |          |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Bobby Charlton</b><br><br>1966   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Flórián Albert</b><br><br>1967   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>George Best</b><br><br>1968      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Gianni Rivera</b><br><br>1969    | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Gerd Müller</b><br><br>1970      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Oleg Blokhin</b><br><br>1975     | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Allan Simonsen</b><br><br>1977 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Paolo Rossi</b><br><br>1982    | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Igor Belanov</b><br><br>1986   | <b>1</b> |



|                                                                                                                       |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Ruud Gullit</b><br><br>1987       | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Lothar Matthäus</b><br><br>1990   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Jean-Pierre Papin</b><br><br>1991 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Roberto Baggio</b><br><br>1993    | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Hristo Stoichkov</b><br><br>1994  | <b>1</b> |
| <b>George Weah</b><br><br>1995       | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Matthias Sammer</b><br><br>1996 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Zinedine Zidane</b><br><br>1998 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Rivaldo</b><br><br>1999         | <b>1</b> |

|                                                                                                                       |          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Luís Figo</b><br><br>2000         | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Michael Owen</b><br><br>2001      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Pavel Nedvěd</b><br><br>2003      | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Andriy Shevchenko</b><br><br>2004 | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Ronaldinho</b><br><br>2005        | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Fabio Cannavaro</b><br><br>2006   | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Kaká</b><br><br>2007            | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Luka Modrić</b><br><br>2018     | <b>1</b> |
| <b>Karim Benzema</b><br><br>2022   | <b>1</b> |

**Rodri**

**1**



2024

**Ousmane Dembélé**

**1**



2025



## Notes

- Lev Yashin remains the only goalkeeper to win the men's award.
- George Weah became the first African winner in 1995.
- Luka Modrić won in 2018.
- The 2020 award was cancelled.
- Ousmane Dembélé won the 2025 award.



## References & review

**Status: review**

Last reviewed: 23 July 2026

- Official winners and rankings (<https://ballondor.com/all-rankings>).
- Official homepage (<https://ballondor.com/>).

Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.